

Reading a Histogram

A **histogram** also uses data bars to visually show data. On a bar graph, the bars represent categories. On a histogram, the bars represent a range of numbers. You can use a histogram to draw conclusions about how frequently events occur.

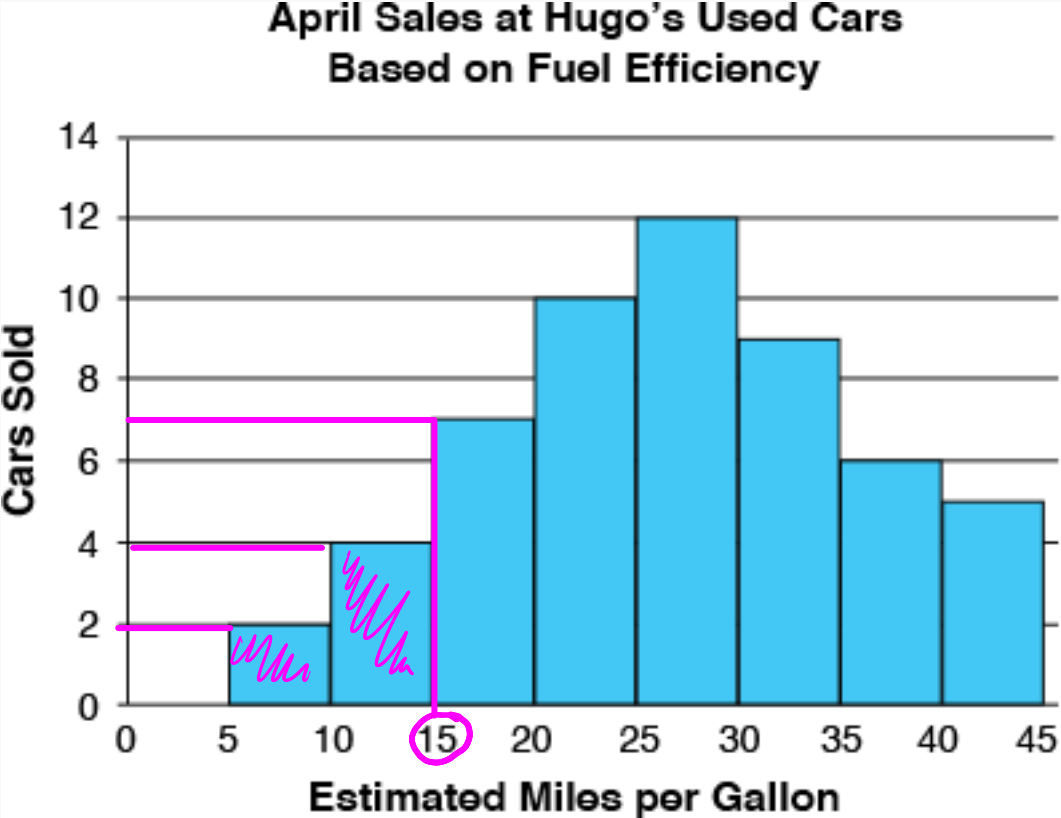
Look at the histogram below. The data is distributed in a shape that is almost symmetrical. The left side is similar to the right side. The values that occur most often are in the center. If a data set has outliers, the histogram becomes skewed. Outliers may pull the center or median of data to the left or to the right.

Each bar on the histogram in the Example below represents an interval. For example, the first bar represents the number of cars sold with an estimated gas mileage of 5 to 9 miles per gallon. Use the vertical axis to read the value of the first bar. Two cars were sold with an estimated gas mileage between 5 and 9 miles per gallon.

Example

Hide

How many cars were sold in April with an estimated gas mileage of less than 15 miles per gallon?



Find 15 on the horizontal axis. The bars to the left of this marker represent cars with a mileage of less than 15 mpg.

Read the values for both bars and find the total.

5 to 9: 2

10 to 14: 4

Total: $2 + 4 = 6$

In April, **6 cars** with an estimated gas mileage of less than 15 mpg were sold.

Rate Your Confidence

^ High

== Medium

Low

Category

Lesson 2: Interpreting Graphs

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